TCS CORPORATE WEBSITE

Form Variations — Authoring Guide

Role / audience	Authoring — Content authors, content managers, AEM authoring leads
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Form Variations — Authoring Guide

Attribute	Value
Document ID	AUT-C-form-variations
Audience	Content authors, content managers, AEM authoring leads
Purpose	How to add, fill in and check the Form Variations component
Scope	—
Prerequisites	—
Owner	Content Lead / AEM Authoring Lead (proposed)
Approver	Product Owner (to be confirmed)
Version	1.0
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Source files	blocks/form-variations/README.md, blocks/form-variations/_form-variations.json
Related documents	—
Related AEM paths	—

1. Where to see it

- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/form-variations
- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/form-variations/field-types
- https://main--tcs-corp--sradha-tcs.aem.live/design-block-master/en/block-library/form-variations/form-variations

2. For Content Authors

1. **Add the block.** In Universal Editor select a Section (or a Columns Container column, or a Tabs Container) and choose Add > Form Variations.
2. **Open its properties.** Select the block; the dialog has the tabs Content and Additional.
3. **Enter the content.** Form Title / Heading (rendered as an H2), Form Description (rich text), Submit action (the endpoint the data is sent to; ask the development team for it) and Theme (Default or Dark).
4. **Add the items.** In the content tree, select the block and use Add to insert items in the order visitors should fill them: Text Input Field, Dropdown / Select Field, Textarea Field, Consent Checkbox Field, Contact Card Output, Submit Button. Reorder them by dragging in the content tree.
5. **Fill each item.** Give every field a unique Field Name / ID (the submitted key, e.g. `firstName`), a label, and set Mandatory Field (*) where needed. For a conditional item, copy the exact dropdown option text into "Show only if dropdown value equals" (or "Show when dropdown value equals" for a contact card).
6. **Preview.** In Universal Editor every conditional item stays visible with an italic condition note; switch to the preview (aem.page) to test the real behaviour.
7. **Publish** the page, then **validate** the published page: an empty Send shows the errors, a valid Send shows "Thank you, your details were sent." only when the endpoint or integration accepted the data.

Minimum required: at least one field item and one Submit Button. **Recommended:** Form Title / Heading, Form Description, Submit action, labels on every field, Input Type Email / Tel where relevant. **Optional:** Theme, conditions, contact cards, Max Character Limit, the Additional tab.

3. Authorable Fields

Form Variations (`form-variations`)

Model `form-variations`; template name "Form Variations" (the block class AEM renders); children: `field-text`, `field-select`, `field-combined`, `field-textarea`, `field-checkbox`, `contact-card`, `field-submit`.

Content tab — Form Variations

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Form Title / Heading	`formHeading`	text	No	—	—	—	Contact us
Form Description	`formDescription`	richtext	No	""	—	—	—
Submit action	`formAction`	aem-content	No	—	—	Where the form data is sent (POST, JSON): e.g. an AEM Forms or spreadsheet submission endpoint. Without it, nothing is sent and visitors are told so.	—
Theme	`classes`	select	No	""	Default (""), Dark (`dark`)	—	dark

Text Input Field (`field-text`)

Model `field-text`; template name "Text Input Field" (the block class AEM renders).

Stored on a new component (definition template): `classes` = `"field-text"`, `inputKind` = `"text"`.

Fields — Text Input Field

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Field type	`classes`	text	No	`field-text`	—	Read only.	—
Field Name / ID	`fieldName`	text	Yes	—	—	Submitted as the field key, e.g. firstName.	firstName
Field Label	`label`	text	Yes	—	—	e.g. First name	First name
Input Type	`inputKind`	select	No	`text`	Text (`text`), Email (`email`), Tel (`tel`)	—	text
Mandatory Field (*)	`required`	boolean	No	`false`	on / off	—	true
Show only if dropdown value equals	`dependsOn`	text	No	—	—	—	Other

Dropdown / Select Field (`field-select`)

Model `field-select`; template name "Dropdown / Select Field" (the block class AEM renders).

Stored on a new component (definition template): `classes` = `"field-select"`.

Fields — Dropdown / Select Field

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Field type	`classes`	text	No	`field-select`	—	Read only.	—
Dropdown Name / ID	`fieldName`	text	Yes	—	—	—	region
Dropdown Label	`label`	text	Yes	—	—	—	Region
Mandatory Field (*)	`required`	boolean	No	`false`	on / off	—	true
Options	`options`	text	No	—	—	—	Asia Pacific, Europe, India, North America
Show only if dropdown value equals	`dependsOn`	text	No	—	—	—	—

Combined Input Field (`field-combined`)

Model `field-combined`; template name "Combined Input Field" (the block class AEM renders).

Stored on a new component (definition template): `classes` = `"field-combined"`.

Fields — Combined Input Field

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Field type	`classes`	text	No	`field-combined`	—	Read only.	—
Field Name / ID	`fieldName`	text	Yes	—	—	Submitted as the field key, e.g. score	—
Mandatory Field (*)	`required`	boolean	No	`false`	on / off	—	—
Show only if dropdown value equals	`dependsOn`	text	No	—	—	—	—

Textarea Field (`field-textarea`)

Model `field-textarea`; template name "Textarea Field" (the block class AEM renders).

Stored on a new component (definition template): `classes` = `"field-textarea"`, `maxLength` = `1500`.

Fields — Textarea Field

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Field type	`classes`	text	No	`field-textarea`	—	Read only.	—
Field Name / ID	`fieldName`	text	Yes	—	—	—	message

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Field Label	`label`	text	Yes	—	—	—	How can we help you?
Max Character Limit	`maxLength`	number	No	`1500`	—	—	1500
Mandatory Field (*)	`required`	boolean	No	`false`	on / off	—	false
Show only if dropdown value equals	`dependsOn`	text	No	—	—	—	—

Consent Checkbox Field (`field-checkbox`)

Model `field-checkbox`; template name "Consent Checkbox Field" (the block class AEM renders).

Stored on a new component (definition template): `classes` = `"field-checkbox"`, `required` = `true`.

Fields — Consent Checkbox Field

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Field type	`classes`	text	No	`field-checkbox`	—	Read only.	—
Checkbox Name / ID	`fieldName`	text	Yes	—	—	—	consent
Consent Text / Disclaimer	`label`	richtext	Yes	—	—	—	—
Mandatory Field (*)	`required`	boolean	No	`true`	on / off	—	true
Show only if dropdown value equals	`dependsOn`	text	No	—	—	—	—

Contact Card Output (`contact-card`)

Model `contact-card`; template name "Contact Card Output" (the block class AEM renders).

Stored on a new component (definition template): `classes` = `"contact-card"`.

Fields — Contact Card Output

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Field type	`classes`	text	No	`contact-card`	—	Read only.	—
Show when dropdown value equals	`region`	text	Yes	—	—	—	India
Contact Name	`contactName`	text	Yes	—	—	—	India media relations
Emails	`emails`	text	No	—	—	—	media.india@example.com, press.india@example.com
Phones	`phones`	text	No	—	—	—	+91 00 0000 0000

Submit Button (`field-submit`)

Model `field-submit`; template name "Submit Button" (the block class AEM renders).

Stored on a new component (definition template): `classes` = `"field-submit"`, `label` = `"Send"`.

Fields — Submit Button

Field label	Property	Type	Required	Default	Allowed values	Author guidance	Example
Field type	`classes`	text	No	`field-submit`	—	Read only.	—
Button Label	`label`	text	No	Send	—	—	Send
Show only if dropdown value equals	`dependson`	text	No	—	—	—	—

Notes the tables can't show:

- **Form Title / Heading** renders as `h2.form-variations-title` and labels the form (`aria-labelledby`); it is also the `dc:title` of `cmp:submit` in the data layer. Without it the form has no accessible name and `cmp:submit` uses the block name.
- **Submit action** is read from the cell's link (`href`), else its text. It receives a `POST` with `Content-Type: application/json` and the body `{ "data": { ... } }`. Without it (and without an integration) nothing is sent; in the editor a note says so.
- **Theme** Dark adds the block class `dark`: a full-width dark panel (`--color-bg-neutral`) with rounded corners, light labels and an inverted primary button.
- **Field Name / ID** (`fieldName`) is the submitted key, sent as written. The dialog marks it required but doesn't validate its characters. A Text Input Field whose name contains "name" (any case) is half width from 900px (`half-width`); every other item is full width. The name also sets `autocomplete` (e.g. `firstName` gives `given-name`, `company` gives `organization`); Input Type Email / Tel set `email` / `tel`.
- **Mandatory Field (*)**: only the value `true` makes a field required; the asterisk is hidden from screen readers and explained once by "* Required fields".
- **Options**: comma separated; a disabled, pre-selected "Select an option" prompt comes first.
- **Max Character Limit**: a value above 0, else 1500; enforced with `maxlength`; the counter shows `count/limit` and announces "{count} of {max} characters".
- **Consent Text / Disclaimer** is rich text: its links are kept and underlined. An empty text shows the field name.
- **Show only if dropdown value equals / Show when dropdown value equals**: the item is shown when *any* enabled dropdown of the form has that value (trimmed, case-insensitive). Hidden items are `hidden`, their controls disabled (left out of validation and the data) and not required.
- **Contact Card Output** Emails become `mailto:` links, Phones `tel:` links (only digits and `+` in the link).
- **Button Label**: empty gives the placeholder `send` ("Send").
- **Legacy mapping.** Items authored before the `fieldName` field (re-audit R-D-1) have fewer cells: their key is read from the item's node name, which AEM delivers in class-name form (`firstName` arrives as `firstname`), unless the node name is only the template name (`text-input-field`, `dropdown-select-field`, `textarea-field`, `consent-checkbox-field`, `contact-card-output`, `submit-button`), in which case the name fallback applies (`text`, `select`, `message`, `consent`). Older markup with the type alone in the first cell is read too.
- **Additional tab.** Anchor ID, Hide block, Animation Type / Motion Speed / Animation Trigger, Background animation and spacing behave as described in AGENTS.md ("Additional tab", "Animation and skeletons"). The content animation moves the block's children; the Background animation reveals the block's own background (visible with Theme Dark).

4. Screenshot-Based Authoring Steps

Authoring Step 1: Add the block and its properties

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
form-variations-authoring-step-1.png

Purpose:
The Form Variations dialog, Content tab, with the title, description and Submit action filled in.

Annotations:
A = Form Title / Heading
B = Form Description
C = Submit action
D = Theme
```

Values to Enter

Call out	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Form Title / Heading	Contact us	Names the form for everyone	H2 above the form; the form is labelled by it
B	Form Description	Tell us about your business challenge and our experts will get back to you within two business days.	Sets expectations	Grey text under the title
C	Submit action	The endpoint provided by the development team	Data must reach a system	Valid submissions are POSTed there
D	Theme	Default	Light pages	45rem-wide form on the page background

Author action: Section > Add > Form Variations; select the block; fill the Content tab. **Expected preview:** title and description render; in the editor, without Submit action, the note "No Submit action set: submissions aren’t sent anywhere." appears. **Expected published result:** the same title and description. **Business rule:** don't publish a form for live data capture without a Submit action or an agreed integration. **Validation:** check the note disappears once Submit action is set. **Common mistake:** leaving Submit action empty: visitors are told the form isn't connected; set it.

Authoring Step 2: Add the fields

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
form-variations-authoring-step-2.png

Purpose:
The content tree under the block with the items added, and the Text Input Field dialog open.

Annotations:
A = Content tree items
B = Field Name / ID
C = Field Label
D = Input Type
E = Mandatory Field (*)
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
B	Field Name / ID	firstName	Submitted key; contains "name"	Half width from 900px; `autocomplete="given-name"`
C	Field Label	First name	Visible label	Label linked to the input
D	Input Type	Text	Plain text	`type="text"`
E	Mandatory Field (*)	on	Needed by the team	Asterisk, required validation
B	Field Name / ID (second item)	lastName	Pairs with firstName	Sits beside First name
D	Input Type (third item, Field Name / ID email, Label Email)	Email	Address format	Email keyboard and format check

Author action: select the block in the content tree > Add > Text Input Field (three times), fill each. **Expected preview:** First name and Last name side by side on desktop, Email full width. **Expected published result:** the same; an address without "@" shows "Enter a valid email address." on Send. **Business rule:** every Field Name / ID unique within the form. **Validation:** open the item again and check every field is set. **Common mistake:** a full-width field named `companyName` turns half width: rename it (e.g. `company`).

Authoring Step 3: Add a dropdown with a conditional contact card

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
form-variations-authoring-step-3.png

Purpose:
The Dropdown / Select Field dialog and a Contact Card Output dialog with the matching value.

Annotations:
A = Dropdown Name / ID
B = Options
C = Show when dropdown value equals
D = Contact Name
E = Emails
F = Phones
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Dropdown Name / ID	region	Submitted key	`region` in the data
B	Options	Asia Pacific, Europe, India, North America	Choices	Four options after "Select an option"
C	Show when dropdown value equals	India	Exact option text	Card shown only for India
D	Contact Name	India media relations	Card heading	Brand-coloured name
E	Emails	media.india@example.com, press.india@example.com	Contact routes	Two `mailto:` links
F	Phones	+91 00 0000 0000	Contact route	One `tel:` link

Author action: Add > Dropdown / Select Field, then Add > Contact Card Output. **Expected preview:** in the editor the card stays visible with "Shown when a dropdown value is "India"". **Expected published**

result: the card appears after a thin divider when India is selected, and the status announces "More fields are shown below.". **Business rule:** one value per conditional item; add another item for another value. **Validation:** select every option on aem.page. **Common mistake:** a condition spelled differently from the option: copy the option text exactly.

Authoring Step 4: Consent and submit

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
form-variations-authoring-step-4.png

Purpose:
The Consent Checkbox Field and Submit Button dialogs.

Annotations:
A = Checkbox Name / ID
B = Consent Text / Disclaimer
C = Mandatory Field (*)
D = Button Label
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	Checkbox Name / ID	consent	Submitted key	`consent: "true"` when checked
B	Consent Text / Disclaimer	I agree to the processing of my personal data as described in the Privacy Notice (with Privacy Notice linked)	Legal consent	Small text with an underlined link
C	Mandatory Field (*)	on (default)	Consent required	Send blocked until checked
D	Button Label	Send	Clear action	Black primary button

Author action: Add > Consent Checkbox Field, Add > Submit Button. **Expected preview:** the checkbox with its text and the Send button. **Expected published result:** Send without the box checked shows "This field is required.". **Business rule:** at least one Submit Button without a condition, so visitors always have a button. **Validation:** check the button is visible before and after choosing each dropdown value. **Common mistake:** every Submit Button conditional: add an unconditional one.

Authoring Step 5: Preview, publish and validate

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
form-variations-authoring-step-5.png

Purpose:
The published form after a valid Send with the success message, the form reset.

Annotations:
A = Reset fields
B = Status "Thank you, your details were sent."
```

Values to Enter

Callout	Field	Value	Reason	Expected result
A	First name / Last name / Email	Test values agreed with the receiving team	End-to-end check	Entry arrives in the receiving system
B	—	—	Outcome	Success message only if the endpoint answered OK

Author action: publish, open the page on aem.live, submit once. **Expected result:** the form resets and the success message receives focus. **Validation:** confirm the entry in the receiving system. **Common mistake:** testing in Universal Editor, where all conditional items are visible: test on aem.page / aem.live.

5. Variations

Default theme

Purpose: a form on a light page. Use it by default; don't use it on a dark section background unless the theme contract of the section (styles/styles.css) gives enough contrast. Required: field items and a Submit Button; optional: title, description. Dialog: Theme = Default. Rendering: centred, at most 45rem wide; one column below 900px, two columns from 900px. Accessibility and data layer as in the sections below. Personalization: none; the authored form renders.

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
form-variations-default-mobile.png

Purpose:
The Default theme at 375 px: single column, full-width fields, Send button left aligned.

Annotations:
A = Title and description
B = Fields in one column
C = Send button
```

Dark theme

Purpose: a highlighted panel (e.g. "Talk to our experts"). Dialog: Theme = Dark (block class `dark`). Rendering: a dark (`--color-bg-neutral`) panel with `--radius-l` corners across the container, content centred at 45rem; padding grows at 600px and 900px; light labels, transparent inputs, a light-blue contact name and status, and the primary button inverted to white. Error colour `#ff6b6b` (hard-coded). Background animation, when chosen, reveals this panel.

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
form-variations-dark-tablet.png

Purpose:
The Dark theme at 768 px: the panel with its tablet padding and a contact card shown for a region.

Annotations:
A = Dark panel
B = Contact card
C = White Send button
```

Half-width name fields

Not a dialog option: a Text Input Field whose Field Name / ID contains "name" gets `half-width` and sits beside the next half-width field from 900px. Use it for First name / Last name; avoid "name" in other field names.

Conditional items

Not a dialog option per se: any field, contact card or Submit Button with a condition value. Rendering: `data-depends-on` on the item's group; hidden and disabled until a dropdown has the value; chains of conditions are resolved; in the editor all are shown with a note and a dashed border.

```
[Screenshot Placeholder]

File name:
form-variations-conditional-desktop.png

Purpose:
Sector set to Other reveals the mandatory "Please specify your sector" input.

Annotations:
A = Controlling dropdown
B = Revealed conditional field
```

6. Complete Authoring Example

Scenario: the "Contact us" form of the block library (`block-library/form-variations/form-variations`, section Main).

Field	Example value	Guidance
Form Title / Heading	Contact us	Short, specific
Form Description	Tell us about your business challenge and our experts will get back to you within two business days.	What happens after sending
Submit action	The agreed endpoint	Required for real submissions
Dropdown / Select Field	region, Region, mandatory, Asia Pacific, Europe, India, North America	Options as conditions will use them
Text Input Field	firstName, First name, Text, mandatory	Half width
Text Input Field	lastName, Last name, Text, mandatory	Half width
Text Input Field	email, Email, Email, mandatory	Format check
Textarea Field	message, How can we help you?, 1500	Counter 0/1500
Consent Checkbox Field	consent, consent text with Privacy Notice link, mandatory	Legal text approved per locale
Submit Button	Send	Unconditional

Steps: add the block, fill the Content tab, add the seven items in that order, publish. Expected output: H2 "Contact us", "* Required fields", the Region dropdown, First name and Last name side by side (desktop), Email, the textarea with 0/1500, the consent checkbox and the Send button. Responsive: one column below 900px. Accessibility: labels, required state, errors linked to fields, focus to the first error, status focused after the outcome. Data layer: the component entry, `cmp:click` on Send, `cmp:submit` with the field names (no values) for a valid submission. Personalization fallback: the authored form. Pre-publish checklist: Submit action set; unique field names; an unconditional Send; an empty Send shows errors; each Region value tested; placeholders translated for the locale; consent text approved.

7. Content and Asset Guidelines

- **Titles and descriptions:** one H2 per form; keep the page H1 elsewhere (e.g. the Page Header). The description says what happens after sending.
- **Labels:** clear, visible, without relying on the description. Don't put essential information only in conditional contact cards.
- **CTAs:** a specific verb on the Submit Button ("Send", "Subscribe"); one visible primary action, extra buttons only when conditional.
- **Links:** only in the consent text (rich text) and contact cards (generated `mailto:` / `tel:`).
- **Images, icons, tags, metadata:** not applicable; the block has no image, icon or tag field and reads no metadata.
- **Min / max items:** no verified technical limit was identified. The textarea limit defaults to 1500 characters.
- **Contact data:** only approved business contacts; sample people and numbers in the library are fictional.
- **Localization:** author labels, options, consent text and cards per locale; keep Field Name / ID identical across locales (data keys); conditions must match the locale's option text; translate the placeholder keys listed under For Site Administrators.

8. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Diagnostic steps	Resolution	Verification
"This form isn’t connected yet" after Send	No Submit action and no integration	Check the Submit action field; in the console listen for `form-variations:submit`	Set the Submit action or add the integration	A valid Send shows the success message
"Your details couldn’t be sent"	Endpoint error, network error or rejected `respondWith` promise	Network tab: the POST status; console	Fix the endpoint / integration	2xx response, success message
A conditional item never appears	Condition text differs from the option, or its dropdown is hidden	Inspect `data-depends-on` on the group	Copy the option text exactly; one value per item	Item appears for that value on aem.page
All conditional items visible	Viewed in Universal Editor	Look for the italic condition notes	Test on aem.page	Only unconditional items initially
No Send button	Every Submit Button conditional, or none added	Check the submit items	Add an unconditional Submit Button	Button visible for every choice
Submitted keys lower-cased	Items authored before `fieldName`	`.plain.html`: count the item's cells	Open the item, set Field Name / ID, republish	Key arrives as written
Values in the wrong field	A missing positional cell (O-18)	`.plain.html`: count the item's cells	Set every field of the item and save	One cell per field
English texts on a locale	Placeholder key missing	Open `/{locale}/placeholders.json`	Add and publish the keys	Translated texts

Evidence to collect (without secrets): page URL on aem.page, the item rows of `{page}.plain.html`, the Network entry of the POST (status only, no personal data), console errors, `window.adobeDataLayer` entries.

9. Screenshots

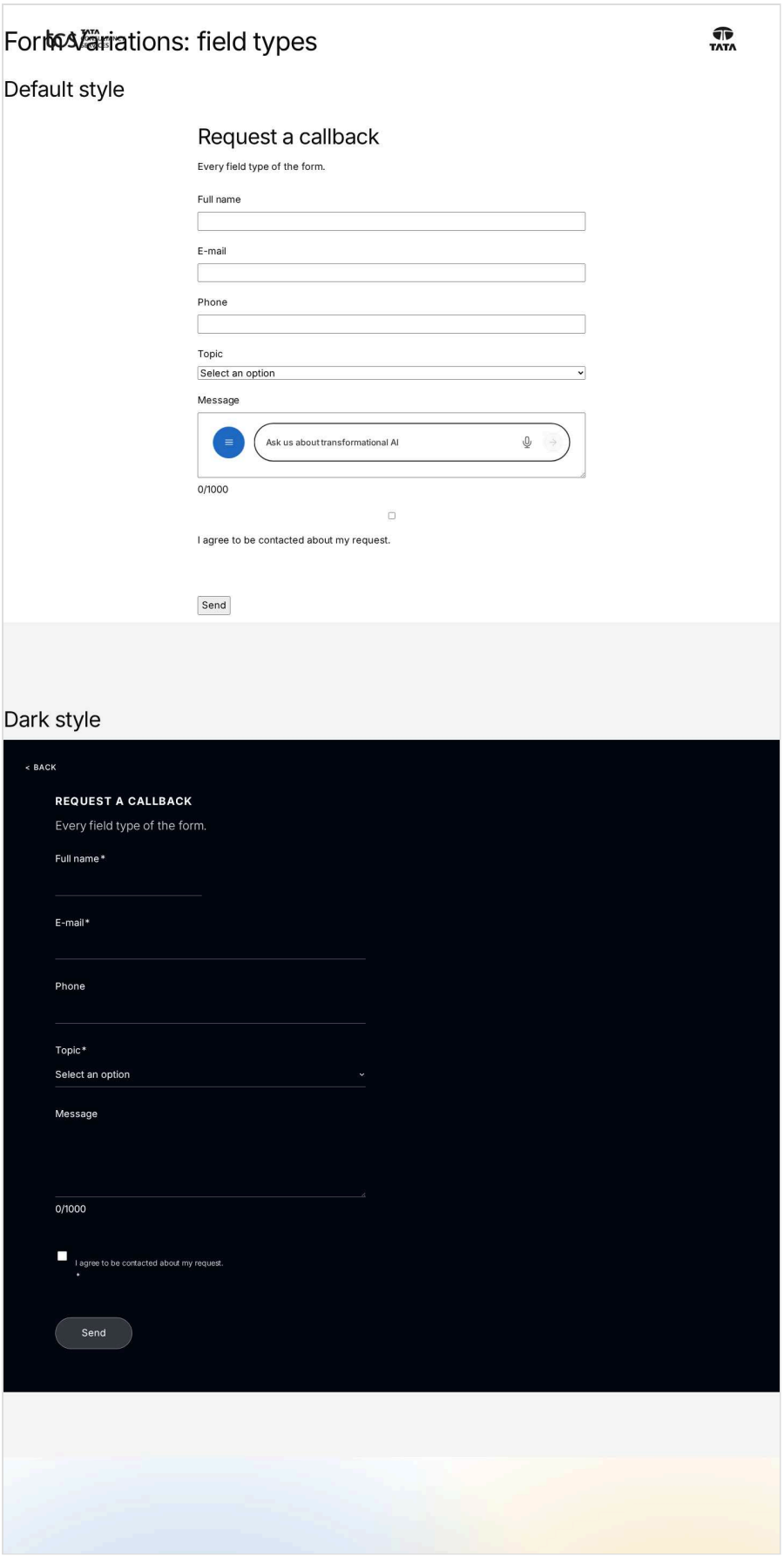


Figure: Form Variations as published (block library) — desktop 1440 × 900 (/design-block-master/en/block-library/form-variations/field-types, captured 2026-11-08).

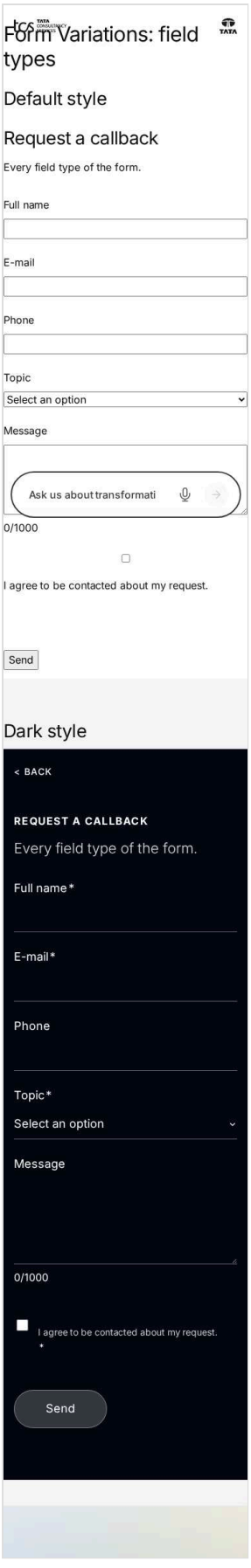


Figure: Form Variations as published (block library) — mobile 375 × 812 (/design-block-master/en/block-library/form-variations/field-types, captured 2026-11-08).

> **Screenshot required**

> - Required screen: Form Variations dialog in Universal Editor (every tab, including Additional)
> - Required role/access: AEM Sites author with Universal Editor (content author)
> - Required navigation steps: AEM Sites console > /content/tcs-corp/language-masters/en > open a page in Universal Editor
> - Reason unavailable: No AEM author access in the documentation program (access blocker AB-01)
> - Owner: Content Lead / AEM Authoring Lead (proposed)
> - Target completion date: To be confirmed

10. Known limitations

- Universal Editor screenshots are placeholders: no author access in this program.

11. Open items

- None.

12. Change history

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	13 November 2026	Delivery team (documentation program)	First version of the role-specific documentation (master documentation prompt), generated from the repository and the published reference pages